

5.0 WINDING THE BABY.

A key part of the baby's feeding routine is burping him. The baby may swallow lots of air while feeding, and burping can help remove some of that gassiness and ease his fussiness. It may also help prevent him from spitting up.

5.1. When should I burp the baby?

There are no rules on when you should burp the baby, some babies need burping during their feed, some after. Look for clues – if the baby seems uncomfortable while feeding, have a little burping break. If they seem fine while feeding, wait until they've finished. The baby will let you know!

5.2 What's the best position to burp the baby?

Support the baby's head and neck, make sure their tummy and back is nice and straight (not curled up), and rub or pat their back gently. You don't need to spend ages burping the baby, a couple of minutes should be enough.

There are a few ways to burp your baby. Try them all out and see which works best – or use a combination:

5.2.1 Over your shoulder



With the baby's chin resting on your shoulder, support the head and shoulder area with one hand, and gently rub and pat your baby's back. It might help to walk around as you are doing this.

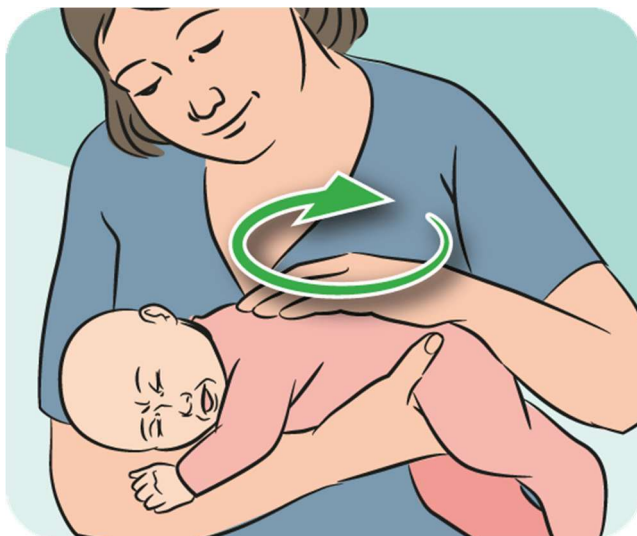
5.2.3 Sitting on your lap

Sit the baby on your lap facing away from you. Place the palm of your hand flat against their chest and support their chin and jaw (don't put any pressure on the throat area). Lean your baby forwards slightly and with your free hand, gently rub or pat your baby's back.



5.2.4 Lying across your lap

Lie your baby across your lap face down. Supporting their chin (don't put any pressure on the throat area), use your free hand to gently rub or pat your baby's back.



5.3 How Long Should You Burp Your Baby?

There is no specific length of time needed for burping the baby. The more important factor is how often you burp him. With that in mind, burp your baby frequently throughout feeds, even when it looks like he doesn't need to be burped.

Waiting until after a feeding to burp the baby may mean your little one has swallowed too much air and may be fussier, so it's better to stop feeding every so often and try to burp your little one. You could also try paced bottle feeding, which slows the flow of breast milk or formula from the bottle, which could help prevent gas.

Here are some tips for burping your baby during a feeding:

- If you're bottle feeding (which can include formula feeding or offering expressed breast milk), you'll want to burp him after every two to three ounces of milk.
- If your baby hasn't burped after some time, go back to feeding. Not every baby burps every time you want him to burp.
- If the baby shows any of the following signs, you may want to burp him more regularly — for example, after every ounce of milk during bottle feeding or every five minutes during breastfeeding:
 - He is gassy
 - He spits up frequently
 - He has Gastroesophageal Reflux Disease (GERD)
 - He seems very fussy.

After a feeding is over, keep your baby in an upright position for 10 to 15 minutes. This can help prevent him from spitting up. You may need to burp him longer if he does spit up or has been diagnosed with GERD.